MIL-B-43444A

30 May 1975

SUPERSEDING
MIL-B-43444
3 August 1966

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BAG, PLASTIC, CONTAMINATED WASTE DISPOSAL

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers two classes and three sizes of plastic bags for use in disposal of contaminated medical waste.

1.2 Classification. Bags shall be of the following classes and sizes (see 6.2).

Class 1 - Light duty.

- Size 1 - 19 inches lay flat width by 20 inches long by 0.0015 inch thick.
- Size 2 - 23 inches lay flat width by 23-1/2 inches long by 0.0015 inch thick.
- Size 3 - 40 inches lay flat width by 45 inches long by 0.0015 inch thick.

Class 2 - Medium duty.

- Size 2 - 23 inches lay flat width by 23-1/2 inches long by 0.003 inch thick.
- Size 3 - 40 inches lay flat width by 45 inches long by 0.006 inch thick.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

* 2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

FSC 8105

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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

L-P-378	-	Plastic Sheet and Strip, Thin Gauge, Polyolefin.
UU-P-268	-	Paper, Kraft, Wrapping.
PPP-B-591	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.
PPP-B-601	-	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-D-723	-	Drums, Fiber.
PPP-T-45	-	Tape, Gummed, Paper, Reinforced and Plain, for Sealing and Securing.
PPP-T-60	-	Tape: Packaging, Waterproof.
PPP-T-76	-	Tape, Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive Paper, (for Carton Sealing).

MILITARY

MIL-L-10547	-	Liners, Case, and Sheet Overwrap; Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-406	-	Plastics: Methods of Testing.
FED-STD-595	-	Colors.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

* 2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

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National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

* 3.1.1 Class 1 bags. Bags in all sizes shall be fabricated from lay flat polyethylene tubing 0.0015 inch thick conforming to type I, grade A, B or C, finish 1 as specified in L-P-378 except that the color shall be opaque yellow No. 23655 of FED-STD-595.

* 3.1.2 Class 2 bags. Bags shall be fabricated from lay flat polyethylene tubing conforming to type I, grade A, B or C, finish 1 as specified in L-P-378 except that the color shall be opaque yellow No. 23655 of FED-STD-595. The size 2 bags shall be fabricated from 0.003 inch thick tubing and the size 3 bags shall be fabricated from 0.006 inch thick tubing.

3.2 Construction put-up and dimensions. The bags shall be put up on a roll in one continuous length. The bags shall be uniformly wound on a convolute or spiral wound paperboard tube with an inside diameter of not less than three inches. The bags shall be heat sealed on one end with the other end open. The bags shall be sealed and perforated in such a manner that the bags may be torn one at a time from the roll. There shall be 900 bags per roll of size 1, class 1, and size 2, classes 1 and 2; 450 bags per roll of size 3, class 1; and 200 bags for size 3, class 2 per roll. All bags shall have a width and length tolerance of $\pm$ 1/2 inch.

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3.3 Performance.

* 3.3.1 Heat seal seam strength. The heat seal seam strength of the bags shall be not less than 60 percent of the film breaking strength when tested in accordance with 4.3.1.

3.4 Workmanship. The bags shall be uniformly made free from pinholes, tears, cuts, creases, wrinkles, or extraneous matter.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

* 4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

* 4.2 Quality conformance inspection. Except as otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105. The acceptable quality levels (AQL) shall be expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

4.2.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, components and materials shall be inspected and tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

* 4.2.2 End item inspection. The end item inspection lot shall be all rolls of bags of the same class and size offered for inspection at one time. The inspection levels AQL, shall be as specified in table I.

TABLE I. Inspection level

Inspection paragraph	Inspection level	AQL Major	AQL Total
4.2.2.1	S-3	2.5	10.0
4.2.2.2	S-3		6.5
4.2.2.3	S-2		2.5
4.2.2.4	S-3		4.0
4.2.3	S-2	2.5	10.0

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* 4.2.2.1 Examination of the end item for defects in construction, appearance, material and workmanship. The sample unit for this examination shall be one roll of bags. Five bags shall be randomly selected from each sample roll and examined in accordance with table II. The inspection level and AQL shall be as listed in table I.

TABLE II. Examination of construction and workmanship

Examine	Defect	Category Major	Category Minor
Construction and workmanship	Not design specified.	101	
	Not formed from one tube of film with single seam.	102	
	Seam not uniform, continuous or adequate.	103	
	Seam edge not perpendicular to sides of bag.	104	
Material	Any blister or fish eye or unfused resin particle. 1/		201
	Not opaque yellow No. 23655.	105	
	Color not uniform throughout bag.		202
Workmanship	Any hole, pinhole, crack, wrinkle, tear, sharp crease, cut, gel defect. 1/	106	
	Any spot, stain or other discoloration.		203
	Not clean, evidence of dirt, grit, oil or other foreign matter on or in bag.	107	
Rolls	Perforations missing between bags.	108	

1/ Sporadic gel defects or unfused resin particles no larger than 1/32 inch in diameter will be acceptable unless occurring in seam.

4.2.2.2 Examination of the end item for dimensional defects. The sample for this examination shall be one bag from each sample roll of bags.

* 4.2.2.3 Testing of the end item. The end item shall be tested for the applicable characteristics as indicated in table III from each lot presented for inspection. The lot size shall be expressed as the number of rolls of bags in the end item inspection lot. The sample shall consist of one bag from each sample roll of bags.

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TABLE III. Testing of the end item

Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test procedure paragraph	Number of tests per sample unit	Results reported as
Heat seal seam strength	3.3.1	4.3.1	2 1/	To nearest percent

1/ Any failure shall constitute a defect.

* 4.2.2.4 Inspection of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing and marking complies with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table IV. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, except that it need not be closed. Defects of closure in table IV shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot.

TABLE IV. Examination of preparation for delivery requirements

Examine	Defect	Category Major	Category Minor
Packaging	Unlike bags on a roll.	101	
Packing	Rolls of unlike bags packed together in the same shipping container.	102	
	Any packing component or material missing, damaged, or not as specified; contents do not fit snugly into shipping container.	103	
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flaps, or case liner, when applicable; insufficient or loose strapping.		201
	Bulged or distorted shipping container.	104	
Weight	Weight of contents of shipping container exceeds requirements.	105	
Marking	Omitted, incomplete, incorrect, illegible or not in accordance with contract requirements.	106	

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4.2.3 Examination of the end item for count. The sample unit for this examination shall be one roll of bags. No more than 2 rolls of bags shall be selected from any one shipping container. The average count per roll shall be not less than the specified quantity for lot acceptability.

* 4.3 Test procedure.

4.3.1 Seam strength. The breaking strength of heat sealed seams (see 3.3.1), shall be determined in accordance with procedure A or B, Method 1013 of FED-STD-406. The specimen shall be not more than 1 inch in width. The initial jaw separation shall be two inches plus or minus 1/16 inch and the seam shall be equidistant plus or minus 1/16 inch between the two jaws. Failure of any test sample to comply with the requirement of 3.3.1, shall be recorded as a defect.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

* 5.1.1 Level A. Bags, put up in roll form as specified in 3.2, shall be restrained from unwinding and wrapped with at least one thickness of 30-pound minimum basis weight kraft paper conforming to type I, grade B of UU-P-268. The wrap shall be lapped approximately six inches and secured the entire length of the roll with a 3-inch minimum width pressure-sensitive or gummed paper tape conforming to PPP-T-76; type III, class 1 or 2 of PPP-T-60; or type III, grade B or C of PPP-T-45. The width of the wrapper shall be such that the wrapper can be folded over the ends of the roll. The folded ends of the wrapper shall be fastened either by tucking into the tube and placing a restraining device into the tube or by gluing a circular piece of paper over the folded wrapper ends. Alternative to wrapping in kraft paper, each roll may be wrapped in polyethylene film identical to that on the roll and the wrap secured with pressure-sensitive tape specified herein or heat sealed.

* 5.1.2 Level C (commercial packaging). Bags shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against physical damage during shipment from the supplier to the first receiving activity. The package and the quantity per package shall be the same as that normally used by the supplier for retail distribution.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

* 5.2.1 Level A. Bags of one class and size only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting shipping container conforming to style RSC (end-opening), grade V2s of PPP-B-636; class II of PPP-B 591; overseas type, type 2 load of PPP-B-601. Each fiberboard container shall be

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waterproofed in accordance with method V as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636. The PPP-B-591 and PPP-B-601 containers shall each be provided with a type I or II, grade C sealed case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547, except when the bags are wrapped in polyethylene film and heat sealed or secured with water resistant tape as specified in 5.1.1. Each shipping container shall be closed and reinforced in accordance with the appendix of the applicable container specification. The weight of the contents for each fiberboard container shall not exceed 65 pounds. The weight of the contents for each of the other shipping containers shall not exceed 150 pounds, except when the weight of a single roll exceeds this amount.

* 5.2.2 Level B. Bags of one class and size only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting shipping container conforming to style RSC (end-opening), type CF (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636; class I, style A or B of PPP-B-591; domestic type, style A or B of PPP-B-601; or type I, grade D of PPP-D-723. Each fiberboard container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636. Each of the other shipping containers shall be closed in accordance with the applicable container specification. The weight of the contents for each fiberboard container shall not exceed 65 pounds. The weight of the contents for each of the other shipping containers shall not exceed 150 pounds, except when the weight of a single roll exceeds this amount.

* 5.2.2.1 When specified (see 6.2), the fiberboard shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of the container specification.

* 5.2.3 Level C (commercial packing). Bags packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. The quantity per shipping container shall be the same as that normally used by the supplier for retail distribution. Containers shall comply with the Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Classification Rules, as applicable.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.3.1 Precautionary marking. The following precautionary marking shall appear in letters not less than 3/4 inch in height on at least one side and wherever practical on two sides of each shipping container:

STAND ON END

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6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Class 1 light duty bags should be used for contaminated medical waste such as cotton, bandages, etc., that are light in weight. Class 2 medium duty bags should be used for contaminated medical waste such as cotton swabs, bandages, etc., that have become saturated with fluids thus making the total load in the bag heavy.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Class and size required (see 1.2).
(c) Selection of the applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) When weather-resistant grade shipping containers are required for level B shipments (see 5.2.2.1).

6.3 The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and suppliers are cautioned to evaluate requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Custodians:

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Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8105-0248

Review activities:

Army - MD, SM, WC
Navy - MS, YD
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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE
Bag, Plastic, Contaminated Waste Disposal MIL-B-43444A

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A
☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?
   A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

   B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?
   ☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

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